

BHARATMILE

Travel & Tourism Across India

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

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1. Executive Summary

BharatMile is an India-focused travel and tourism platform designed to help domestic and international travellers discover destinations, plan itineraries, and book affordable travel experiences across the length and breadth of India. This document defines the product vision, target users, feature set, success metrics, and release roadmap for the v1.0 public launch.

India's domestic travel market is one of the fastest-growing in the world, projected to surpass USD 50 billion by 2028. BharatMile aims to capture a meaningful share of this market by focusing on budget-conscious travellers, experience-based tourism, and underserved Tier-2 and Tier-3 destinations that larger OTAs overlook.

2. Problem Statement

Key user pain-points the product addresses:

Fragmented discovery	Travellers must browse multiple websites to research destinations, hotels, transport, and activities.
Metro-centric content	Most travel platforms over-index on popular metros and miss thousands of remarkable smaller destinations.
Budget opacity	Hidden costs and unclear pricing make it difficult to plan a trip on a fixed budget.
Language & localisation gap	English-only interfaces alienate a large segment of regional-language speakers.
Lack of personalisation	Generic itinerary suggestions do not account for travel style, group composition, or past preferences.

3. Goals & Non-Goals

Goals

- Create a single-stop discovery and planning platform for Indian travel.
- Surface authentic, budget-friendly experiences across all 36 states and union territories.
- Provide transparent pricing with no hidden fees at the point of discovery.
- Support at least 6 Indian regional languages at launch.
- Build a community layer (reviews, photos, trip stories) that generates organic content.
- Achieve a seamless mobile-first experience (PWA + native apps).

Non-Goals (v1.0)

- International travel booking or visa assistance.
- White-label B2B platform for travel agents.
- In-house hotel or transport operations — we are a marketplace, not an operator.
- Real-time flight booking (planned for v2.0).

4. Target Users & Personas

■ The Budget Backpacker	Age 20–30, college students and young professionals seeking affordable weekend getaways and offbeat destinations within a ■5,000–■15,000 budget per trip.
■■■■■■■ The Family Planner	Age 30–45, planning annual family holidays. Values convenience, safety, kid-friendly activities, and clear all-inclusive pricing.
■ The Experience Seeker	Age 25–40, interested in wellness retreats, cultural immersion, adventure sports, and culinary tourism rather than standard sightseeing.
■ The NRI Traveller	Indian diaspora travelling back to India 1–2 times per year who need up-to-date, reliable destination information in English.
■■ The Solo Explorer	Age 22–35, solo travellers (especially solo women) who need safety information, community reviews, and flexible single-traveller packages.

5. Feature Requirements

5.1 Destination Discovery Engine

Feature	Description	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Search & Filters	Full-text search with filters: region, state, budget, season, activity type, trip duration, group type.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P0
Curated Collections	Editorial collections: 'Hidden Gems', 'Under ■10K Weekend Trips', 'Best Monsoon Destinations', 'Solo-Friendly Places'.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1
Interactive Map	Pan-and-zoom India map with destination pins, clustered by region. Tap a pin to view a destination card.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1
AI Trip Planner	Conversational interface where users input preferences and receive a day-by-day itinerary with estimated costs.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P2

5.2 Destination Pages

Feature	Description	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Overview & Highlights	Hero image gallery, best time to visit, how to reach, local tips, climate chart.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P0
Things To Do	Categorised activities (adventure, spiritual, culinary, nature, heritage) with difficulty ratings and cost ranges.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1
Where To Stay	Budget (hostels), mid-range (homestays, hotels), premium (resorts). Verified pricing with direct booking links.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1
Getting There	Transport options (train, bus, flight, road) with approximate costs and journey times from major cities.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P2
User Reviews & Photos	Verified traveller reviews with photo uploads. Upvote/downvote and helpful-flag system.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P2

5.3 Trip Planning & Booking

Feature	Description	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Itinerary Builder	Drag-and-drop day planner. Add destinations, activities, stay options. Export as PDF or share via link.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P0
Package Listings	Third-party tour operator packages with transparent inclusions, exclusions, and pricing.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1
Price Comparison	Side-by-side comparison of hotel and package prices from partner providers.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1
Secure Checkout	UPI, Net Banking, Credit/Debit card, and EMI options. GST invoice generation.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P2

5.4 Community & Content

Feature	Description	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Trip Stories	Long-form user travel blogs with rich media. SEO-optimised for organic discovery.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P0
Q&A; Forum	Destination-specific Q&A; threads. Verified local expert badges.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1
Travel Groups	Interest-based groups (e.g., 'Solo Women Travellers', 'Budget Himalaya Trips') with group trip coordination tools.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1

5.5 Notifications & Personalisation

Feature	Description	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Deal Alerts	Push/email alerts for price drops on saved destinations and packages.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P0
Seasonal Recommendations	Contextual suggestions based on current season and user's location.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1
Saved Trips	Bookmark destinations and itineraries to a personal travel wishlist.	Functional on web & mobile; load < 2s; accessible (WCAG 2.1 AA)	P1

6. Feature Prioritisation

Features are prioritised using a RICE-inspired framework. P0 = must-have for launch; P1 = launch target; P2 = post-launch; P3 = future roadmap.

Priority	Feature	Owner	Sprint
P0	Destination Search & Filters	Product + Engineering	Sprint 1–2
P0	Destination Detail Pages	Product + Content	Sprint 1–3
P0	User Registration & Auth	Engineering	Sprint 1
P0	Mobile-Responsive Web (PWA)	Frontend Engineering	Sprint 2–4
P1	AI Trip Planner (MVP)	AI / ML Team	Sprint 4–6
P1	Itinerary Builder	Product + Engineering	Sprint 5–6
P1	Package Listing & Checkout	Engineering + BD	Sprint 5–7
P1	User Reviews & Photos	Product + Engineering	Sprint 3–5
P1	Regional Language Support (6 langs)	Engineering + L10n	Sprint 6–8
P2	Community Trip Stories & Q&A;	Content + Engineering	Sprint 8–10
P2	Deal Alerts & Notifications	Engineering	Sprint 9–10
P2	Travel Groups & Group Trip Tools	Product + Engineering	Sprint 10–12
P3	Real-Time Flight Search Integration	Engineering + BD	Post-Launch
P3	Native iOS & Android Apps	Mobile Engineering	Post-Launch

7. Technical Architecture Overview

Frontend	Next.js 14 (App Router) — SSR for SEO, React for interactivity. Tailwind CSS. PWA support.
Mobile Apps	React Native (iOS & Android) — v2.0 roadmap.
Backend API	Node.js / TypeScript with NestJS. RESTful + GraphQL endpoints.
Database	PostgreSQL (relational data), Redis (caching & sessions), Elasticsearch (search).
AI / ML	LLM-powered trip planner via API (Claude / GPT-4). Personalisation via collaborative filtering.
Content CDN	Cloudflare CDN for images and static assets. WebP/AVIF format with lazy loading.

Payments	Razorpay for UPI, cards, EMI. PCI-DSS compliant.
Analytics	Mixpanel (product analytics), Google Analytics 4, Hotjar (session recordings).
Infrastructure	AWS (ap-south-1, Mumbai). ECS + Fargate. RDS Aurora. S3 + CloudFront.
Monitoring	Datadog APM, PagerDuty on-call, Sentry for error tracking.

8. Non-Functional Requirements

Performance	Core Web Vitals green. LCP < 2.5s, FID < 100ms, CLS < 0.1 on 4G networks.
Availability	99.9% uptime SLA. Zero-downtime deployments.
Scalability	Handle 100k concurrent users at launch; horizontally scalable to 1M+.
Security	OWASP Top 10 mitigated. Data encrypted at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3). VAPT before launch.
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 AA compliance across all pages.
SEO	Server-side rendering for all content pages. Structured data (Schema.org/TouristAttraction). Sitemap auto-generation.
Localisation	i18n framework; RTL support for Urdu; 6 languages at launch: Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Bengali, Marathi.
Data Privacy	IT Act 2000 + DPDP Act 2023 compliant. Explicit consent for data collection. Right to erasure.

9. Success Metrics & KPIs

Metric	Baseline	6-Month Target	12-Month Target
Monthly Active Users (MAU)	0	50,000	250,000
Registered Users	0	100,000	500,000
Destination Pages Published	500	2,000	5,000
Booking Conversion Rate	—	2.5%	4.0%
Gross Merchandise Value (GMV)	■0	■2 Cr/mo	■10 Cr/mo
App Store Rating	—	≥ 4.3	≥ 4.5
Session Duration (avg)	—	4 min	7 min
User-Generated Reviews	0	10,000	75,000
NPS Score	—	≥ 40	≥ 55
Organic Search Traffic Share	—	40%	60%

10. Release Roadmap

Alpha (Internal) Sprints 1–4	Core infra setup, 500 destination pages, search & filters, user auth, basic itinerary builder, team testing.
Beta (Closed) Sprints 5–8	Package listings, checkout, user reviews, regional language MVP (Hindi + Tamil), influencer and community user group invited.
Launch v1.0 Sprints 9–10	Public launch, 2,000+ destinations, all 6 languages, AI trip planner, marketing campaign, PR.
Post-Launch v1.1 Sprints 11–14	Deal alerts, community stories, travel groups, performance optimisations, native app beta.
v2.0 Sprints 15–20	Real-time flight search, native iOS & Android GA, B2B partner portal, loyalty programme.

11. Risks & Mitigations

Content quality at scale	HIGH	Hire regional content specialists; UGC moderation pipeline with AI + human review.
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Low initial organic traffic	HIGH	6-month SEO content sprint pre-launch; destination guides targeting long-tail keywords.
Payment gateway failures	MEDIUM	Multi-PSP fallback (Razorpay + PayU); retry logic; real-time monitoring.
OTA competition (MakeMyTrip, EaseMyTrip)	HIGH	Differentiate on depth (Tier-2/3 destinations), UGC, and budget transparency.
Regulatory (DPDP Act 2023)	MEDIUM	Legal counsel engaged; consent management platform integrated at launch.
Seasonal traffic spikes	MEDIUM	Auto-scaling infra; load tested at 5× peak before launch.

12. Open Questions

- Should BharatMile operate its own hotel/package inventory (merchant model) or remain purely a marketplace? Decision required by Sprint 3.
- Which 6 regional languages are prioritised for v1.0? Recommendation: Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Bengali, Marathi — awaiting stakeholder sign-off.
- Monetisation split between affiliate commission, listing fees, and premium subscriptions — finalise revenue model before Beta.
- Should the AI Trip Planner be powered in-house or via API? Evaluate build vs. buy in Sprint 3.
- Partnership structure with IRCTC and State Tourism Boards — legal/BD to initiate conversations by Sprint 2.

13. Appendix — Glossary

OTA	Online Travel Agency
GMV	Gross Merchandise Value
PWA	Progressive Web App
NPS	Net Promoter Score
RICE	Reach, Impact, Confidence, Effort — prioritisation framework
UGC	User-Generated Content
VAPT	Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing
DPDP	Digital Personal Data Protection Act (India, 2023)
LCP	Largest Contentful Paint — Core Web Vitals metric
L10n	Localisation

